G3: Limited Data Build for Inventory Change Feature Reference Document v2.0

G3: Limited Data Build for Inventory Change Feature Reference Document v2.0 by Jason Barnett

- Introduction
  - Document overview

The purpose of this document is to provide an overview of the Limited Data Build for Inventory Change Solution and workflow.

- Limited Data Build for Inventory Change solution overview

Limited Data Build (LDB) is a solution for building the data from an alternate source when sufficient, representative historical data that IDeaS G3 RMS requires to build the system and forecast with is not available from the PMS. Commonly, this solution is used for properties that are newly opened and have no historical data or properties that are open and have some historical data available but don't have a full year of history.

For properties that have previously met IDeaS minimum historical data requirement and have been on G3 RMS for at least 110 days but are now undergoing a major change in their inventory that will affect the reliability of the historical data for some but not all of the property's inventory, these properties would formerly have been required to use IDeaS standard LDB solution. Real historical patterns and room sold data would've been replaced entirely with patterns and sales projections from the Limited Data Build configuration.

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Common scenarios like these include:

- A property is increasing total property capacity by 10% or more.
- A property is going thru a room renovation and new room type(s) are being added and/or the capacity of existing room types or room classes is changing significantly.

The **"Limited Data Build for Inventory Change"** version of our LDB solution allows G3 RMS to make use of your property's own learned historical booking patterns and historical solds data for the room types that have sufficient, representative history. And, use sales projections data provided by the property for rooms types that lack representative historical data. This combination of real data and projections is used by G3 RMS to build the forecast and decisions with so the impact of your inventory change can be taken into immediate consideration, before actual data is available.

- Prerequisites to use LDB for Inventory Change

Determination of which LDB solution is applicable needs to be made by IDeaS Revenue Optimization Analyst (ROA) team and a support case should be opened with ROA to review the data conditions before implementing this solution. This is also a chargeable feature so commercials need to be signed before this can be implemented. Minimum requirements to use this include:

- Property has been installed on G3 RMS as a Standard build for 110 pace days
- At least 20% of the property inventory has at least one full year of historical solds data and is considered representative for forecasting
- Room Type code and/or Capacity changes must already be made in the PMS and present in the data received by IDeaS
- The Property has purchased the Limited Data Build for Inventory Change setup and subscription

Note – for properties with Component Rooms there is a different process and additional pre-requisites to use.

- Solution
  - LDB for Inventory Change Workflow

There are many similarities with the workflow for the full Limited Data Build solution and a few key differences. This section will outline the high-level workflow.

Key differences with standard LDB solution:

- The property will be converting from Standard build
- Activation of this solution is managed by IDeaS from a toggle under Support>Installation>Property>Core Settings tab.
- Solution works with analytical Market Segments (MS) and straight in MS, AMS does not need to be switched off and property can continue using their existing MS and Forecast Groups (FG).
- Property does not need to provide alternate pattern source data. The build will use the property's own learned booking patterns.
- Projected Rooms and Revenue data only needs to be provided for the impacted inventory, not the entire property
- IP related parameters typically changed for standard LDB solution do not change
- Will continue to use booked data if already using booked data
- Rebuild (Rollback/Catchup) is not required at the end of the LDB to convert back to a Standard Build.

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Implementation workflow:

Before implementing this solution, the details of the inventory change should be shared with the Revenue Optimization Analyst (ROA) team for review. ROA must approve this solution before implementing. And, necessary commercials need to be first signed by the client. High-level workflow is as follows

1. Client and IDeaS verify that the inventory changes have been made in the PMS and are received by IDeaS G3 RMS.
2. CRM/ERM Open a Support Case
3. CARE activates the Limited Data Build for Inventory Change solution
4. Client completes the required LDB and system configuration updates
5. CARE runs the Limited Data Build process. Client may elect to have the mode changed to Decision Creation Mode
6. ROA and Client reviews and approves the Forecast and Decisions
7. System Mode is switched back to Decision Delivery Mode, as required. Initial Builds is complete.
8. Build recalibration and switch to Standard build at conclusion are addressed in sections 2.4 LDB Recalibration and 2.5 LDB Conclusion and Switch to Standard Build, respectively.

SFDC Case workflow:

Open 'Limited Data Build for Inventory Change' Case Type

Task 1 – LDB for Inventory Change solution activation

- CARE selects Client and Property. From Support>Installation>Property>Core Settings, mark the toggle next to Limited Data Build for Inventory Change and click Save.

Task 2 – CRM/ERM requests the G3 RMS User complete their configuration under Configure>Limited Data Build

- Client configuration tasks are outlined in detail under 2.2 LDB Build Preparation and 2.6 User Interface section, but include:
  1) identify affected Room Types
  2) upload sales projections for affected Room Types
  3) general system configuration updates

Task 3 – Client confirms LDB configuration is complete

- CRM/ERM verify key configuration from Support>Limited Data Build>Property Build Status
- Update Task 4 scheduled date for CARE; note if the client would like the Mode changed from Decision Delivery to Decision Creation Mode

Task 4 – Run LDB job

- CARE updates the Mode, as required
- CARE runs LDB job from Support>File Upload tab.
- Upon successful completion, LDB UI is locked
- CARE updates tasks 5 and 6 scheduled date.

Task 5 – ROA forecast decision review

- Result provided to CRM/ERM

Task 6 – Client review

- CRM/ERM informs client of build completion. Requests client complete forecast decision review.

Task 7 – Client Approval/Mode Change

- CRM/ERM to schedule task for CARE to change the Mode to Decision Delivery, as required
- If Mode change is not required, Close Task

Task 8A1 – ROA Forecast Review

- Task schedule date = 3 days earlier than "Select the first date when the final rooms sold data will have normalized" date
- ROA to review the forecast and decisions to identify if recalibration and/or mask period removal would be recommended.
- ROA to share the feedback with the CRM/PM upon which CRM/PM can decide further action
- If Date is already past, Close Task

Task 8A2 – Care to perform the recalibration (Optional)

- Close Task if not required

Task 8A3 – ROA Forecast Review (Optional)

- If recalibration was suggested by ROA in Task 8A1, another Forecast review task to be assigned to ROA post the recalibration is done.
- Close task if not required

Task 8B1 – ROA Forecast Review (Optional)

- If the above 'Task schedule date' is more than 6 months from initial LDB build date periodic forecast & decisions review task should be assigned to ROA once in every 3 months from the initial build date
- ROA to review the forecast and decisions to identify if recalibration and/or mask period removal would be recommended
- Close task if not required

Task 8B2 – Care to perform the recalibration (Optional)

- Close task if not required

Task 8B3 – ROA Forecast Review (Optional)

- If recalibration was suggested by ROA in Task 8B1, another Forecast review task to be assigned to ROA post the recalibration is done.
- Close task if not required

Task 9 –LDB Conclusion – Switch to Standard Build

- Scheduled Date assigned as 365 days from first real data start date
- CARE/ROA verifies system has sufficient historical data available
- CARE from Support>Installation>Property>Core Settings switches off the Limited Data for Inventory Change toggle

Task 10 – Notify Client

- CRM/ERM notifies client that build type has switched to Standard

Task 11 – Close Case

- Case owner Closes Case
    - LDB Build Preparation Steps

G3 RMS System Configuration

The G3 RMS user is required to have completed the following system configuration in G3 RMS UI reflecting their inventory changes before the Limited Data Build can be run:

- Rooms Configuration – Room Type to Room Class configuration, Cost of Walk, Overbooking, and Price Ranking and Upgrade Path
- Market Segment Attribution – all market segments must be attributed
- If competitor rate shop data is being populated, Rate Shopping Configuration needs to be configured

LDB by Room Type Data Inputs

The G3 RMS user is expected to provide the below data inputs which will be utilized by the system to forecast by simulating the historical data that is not available to IDeaS.

1. Identify Impacted Room Types

- The G3 RMS user will identify each Room Type that is impacted by the Inventory change. Impacted Room Types include room types that have no historical data (e.g. a new Room Type) or there is historical data but it isn't representative of the volume and value of demand expected for that room type going forward (e.g. the capacity or value of the Room Type is increasing or decreasing significantly). The G3 RMS user is expected to provide sales projections data as an alternative to using historical data for these room types.

2. Select the first date when the final rooms sold data will have normalized

- The hotel identifies the date when all impacted inventory is expected to be behaving normally and can be considered representative for the system to use when forecasting volume and value of demand from the final solds. For the impacted room types, the system will ignore the final solds data for dates before this. For non-impacted room types the system will continue to use final solds as usual.

3. Volume and Value of Demand for each Market Segment

- Provided in the form of Projected Rooms Sold and Revenue by Occupancy Date for each Market Segment for the room types and period that is lacking representative historical data. Data is entered as total rooms and total revenue for each Market Segment for each Occupancy Date for the impacted room types only, and not rooms and revenue projections for the entire property. Projections should not include Room and Revenue projected for non-impacted inventory.

Example: G3 RMS user is providing projections for MS 'BAR' for 02-Jan-2020. RT2 and RT3 are selected as impacted, RT1 is not.

Rooms/Revenue

RT1 = 50/5000

RT2 = 15/1900

RT3 = 5/800

Projected Rooms = RT2+RT3=15+5=20

Projected Revenue = RT2+RT3=1900+800=2700

- A minimum of 365 days projections data or combination of actual history plus projection days is required.
  - LDB by RT Build

Once the LDB preparation steps are completed for a property, the IDeaS team completes the Limited Data Build by running the Build job on an agreed schedule. After Limited Data Build is run, a sync job will need to be run. And, the property is recommended to review the forecast and decisions.

The System will simulate history for the impacted Room Types and pace based upon the projections and pattern information provided until the hotel has representative actual history and the property build can switch to the standard build.

The Client will be responsible for reviewing system forecasts and decisions throughout the Limited Data Build implementation. Properties are recommended to periodically review projections to make sure they are in line with how business materialized. Concerns with the System forecast, or decisions should be escalated thru the established Support process.

- LDB Recalibration

After the first Limited Data Build, if after some time the G3 RMS user observes that actual business materialization differs significantly from the hotel's original assumptions the G3 RMS User will have the opportunity to revise their LDB data inputs and run the Limited Data Build process again. Generally, this option is utilized if the difference is major, the period is lengthy, and cannot be easily managed using the demand or pricing override.

To update the LDB configuration and run the LDB build again, the G3 RMS user will open a support case with IDeaS. The contract will include one free LDB recalibration after the initial Limited Data Build. Additional build recalibrations may be requested but each run is chargeable. After each LDB recalibration is run, the Limited Data Build Configuration screen becomes Read Only and the screen must be unlocked by IDeaS CARE before the configuration is editable again.

If the date when the final rooms sold data for the impacted inventory will normalize is 6 months into the future, IDeaS ROA may recommend a recalibration be run. These aren't considered chargeable and will not count against the recalibration included in the contract.

Data updates permitted for recalibration:

- Changing projection data
- Changing the date the system can begin using actual history
- Any combination of the above
    - LDB Conclusion and Switch to Standard Build

Once the property has sufficient representative historical data for all impacted inventory, a support case will need to be opened for IDeaS CARE to switch the property to the Build type to a standard build. Unlike the full LDB solution, rollback and catch up is not required to convert the Build type to standard.

- User Interface

Limited Data Build – Select Room Types tab

G3 RMS requires the G3 RMS user identify each room type that does not have sufficient, representative historical data and the system is expected to use the projected rooms and revenue to simulate historical demand.

From the Select Room Type tab, identify each room type that is impacted by checking the box in the row.

Steps to configure Projected Rooms Sold & Room Revenue

1. Point to Configure and click Limited Data Build.
2. Click Select Room Types.
3. Review the table to verify all Room Type Codes are present with correct capacity
4. Click the check box to indicate an impacted Room Type.

Limited Data Build — Projections Tab

Use the Projections tab in Limited Data Build to provide G3 RMS with the data that it needs to build your property. These inputs include:

- First date when the final rooms sold data will have normalized: In the upper section you are expected to select the first date when the final rooms sold data for the impacted inventory is expected to normalize and the system can begin treating this data as representative history.
- Projected Rooms Sold and Revenue: Projection data provides the system with values for the number of rooms and revenue that you expect the property to achieve for the impacted inventory. Data must be entered by market segment for each occupancy date for the future period that is lacking historical solds data. Projections data is provided as a total value by day for the impacted inventory only.

Use the Projections tab to provide the data needed to build simulated history for your impacted Room Types, starting with the date when the system can begin treating final solds as representative data to forecast future demand with.

1. From **Configure,** click Limited Data Build.
2. Click Projections.
3. Define the **First date when the final rooms sold data will have normalized** date from the upper section.
4. Click **Save**.

Entering Projected Rooms and Room Revenue

Use the Projected Rooms Sold and Revenue configuration to provide G3 RMS with your sales and revenue projections for at least 365 days. In an exported template, you enter the number of rooms that you expect to sell and the revenue that you expect to earn for each market segment and occupancy date for the impacted room types only.

G3 RMS uses these values, along with booking patterns and business on books, to begin forecasting and producing decisions. The system distributes the data to Room Classes primarily according to their capacities.

Steps to configure Projected Rooms Sold & Room Revenue

1. From Configure, click Limited Data Build.
2. Click Projections.
3. From the lower section, click the calendar icons to select the Start Date and End Date:

- The Start Date to End Date will define the period the projections will be entered for. The Start Date will default to System Date +1. The End Date should be defined to cover the entire period which is lacking representative historical data. This is ordinarily the "
- G3 RMS requires a minimum of 365 days Projections data (or combined with actual history) when the process is run. However, smaller periods can be downloaded and uploaded if adjustments are being made.

4. Click Download.
5. Save the workbook to a location on your computer.
6. Complete the Projected Data Template
7. Save the modified file in XLSX format.
8. From Projections, click Upload.
9. Navigate to and select the saved workbook.
10. Click Open.

Project Details

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3.0	11-June-2019	ROA Task updates in the workflow section	Joykrishna

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